

Constitution of Unity

Article I: Name Section 1: The name of this organization shall be... Unity here after referred to as... Unity

Article II:

Purpose Section 1: The purpose of this organization will be to connect underrepresented mentors on campus with underrepresented incoming students. Through this connection, mentors will educate mentees on academic support on campus, mental health, and how to create a healthy social life at Furman University. Mentors will also learn about the impact of leadership and public service through relationships with their mentees.

Article III:

Affiliations Section 1: This organization is affiliated with the Furman University Student Diversity Council.

Article IV: Membership

Section 1: The membership of this organization shall consist of enrolled Furman University students.

Section 2:

This organization and its members shall not discriminate against any individuals for reasons of race, national origin, color, religion, gender, age, veteran status, sexual orientation, and/or ability status.

Section 3:

Membership in this group shall be open to all who are interested, for the 2021-2022 academic year, and do not have any violations against campus offices such as but not

limited to (Academic Dean's office, Title IX and etc.).
Individuals can appeal on a case by case basis and must be approved by the executive board and the faculty advisor.

Article V:

Officers Section 1: The officers of the organization shall consist of... (State all officer titles and duties – examples below)

A. President – The President shall

- (a)** Preside over all meetings and act as chair of the Executive Committee.
- (b)** Appoint the Chair and members of all Committees, if committees are active in the Chapter.
- (c)** Act with general executive authority between meetings of the Executive Committee and General Membership Meeting.
- (d)** Act as Ex-officio member of all other committees.
- (e)** Give vision and plan for activities, current issues, and agenda of the Chapter for the coming year at the first meeting of the new school year.
- (f)** Countersign all checks and properly supported requisitions for the disbursements of program funds.
- (g)** Begin each school year with a first meeting statement outlining goals and priorities of the year.
- (h)** Inform the Executive Committee of any prolonged absences from the campus

C. Secretary - The Secretary shall

- (a)** To act as Secretary of the College Chapter and the Executive Committee
- (b)** To give due notice of all meetings of the College Chapter and the Executive Committee
 - (i)** To give members notice of regular meetings and three calendar days' notice of special meetings.
- (c)** To record and maintain the minutes from meetings in a minute book.
- (d)** To be in charge of the organization's master schedule of activities and room reservations

D. Treasurer - The Treasurer shall

- (a)** To receive all monies of the program and promptly deposit the same in the name of the program in a separate account(s) in a responsible bank or other responsible student depository
 - (i)** No money shall be withdrawn from any such account, except by check signed by the Treasurer and countersigned by the President.
- (b)** To make authorized disbursements upon requisitions signed by the Secretary and counter- signed by the President
 - (i)** Each requisition shall recite the amount and purpose of the payment requested.
 - (ii)** Every requisition in the amount of twenty-five dollars (\$25.00) or more must further be approved by the Executive Committee before payment
- (c)** Keep records of all income and expenditures
- (d)** Obtain the approval of the Executive Committee before writing all checks more than \$50.00, not including budget items
- (e)** Assist in determining the feasibility of proposed activities by informing the Executive Committee of the organization's financial status
- (f)** Be prohibited from discussing the financial status of the organization with any non-member without prior approval from the Executive Committee
- (g)** Keep a record of all Chapter members and their dues
- (h)** To give receipts for all membership fees received and to transmit such fees to the organization's Treasurer.
- (k)** In conjunction with the President, to sign requisitions for disbursements from Unity's treasury and to maintain a file of receipts for disbursements.

Section 2: The qualifications for each office... (State the qualifications, if any, for the offices)

Section 3: The term of each office shall be one year, starting at the end of an academic school year and ending exactly one year later, at the end of the next academic year.

Section 4: Should an officer's position become vacant during his/her term, the president will appoint another member to take their place, or the members will vote to do a majority vote for a new person to take the position.

Article VI: Advisor

*Section 1: Our organization advisor must be a member of the faculty, administration, or staff of Furman University. (See Advisor Guidelines in the "Guidelines & Policies Affecting Organization")

Section 2: The duties and responsibilities of the advisor shall be Help with facilitating the organization and Actively support the organization. (See Advisor Guidelines in the "Guidelines & Policies Affecting Organization")

Section 3: Should the position of advisor become vacant during the year the members of the organization will have a majority vote for a new advisor.

Article VII:

Meetings Section 1: Regular meetings of the organization shall be held once a month. (Consider how often you would like to meet, who calls the meeting, etc.)

Section 2: Special meetings of the organization shall be held to plan for important events and will be called upon by the president. (Consider who has authority to call these meetings, etc.) Should another member desire to call a meeting, they need to inform the President, and leave the decision up to the President.

Article VIII: Amendments

Section 1: This constitution shall be amended by a vote of (2/3, 3/4, etc.) majority of the membership at any regular or special meeting. (Note: The constitution should not be amended easily or frequently)

Section 2: Provision for advance notice of amendment shall be through email and will be announced at least 2 weeks before the voting process. (Explain how eligible voting members will be informed of the proposed amendment such as posting, notification by email, announcement at two consecutive meetings, etc.)

Sample By-Laws

By-Laws of Unity

Article I: Membership

Section 1: The procedure for selection of membership will be through an application sent out during the beginning of the spring semester.

Section 2: Dues for this organization shall be \$20 for the year (\$10 each semester)

Section 3: Membership responsibilities shall include attending all meetings and giving updates on your progress connecting with mentees.

Section 4: Membership shall be terminated by failure to reach out to mentees at all, major violations on campus (e.g. Title IX), and failure to meet organization expectations.

Article II: Selection of Officers

Section 1 The selection of officers shall be done by majority vote of the members of the organization. (Clearly state

election rules and voting procedures, eligibility for each office, and when the elections take place during the academic year)

Section 2: The provisions for removal of an officer include:

- (a) For removal of office, any member of the executive committee can propose to remove an officer with just cause. The proposal must be approved by two-thirds of the Executive Committee and two-thirds of the General Membership

Article III: Selection of Advisor

Section 1 The selection of the advisor shall be done by a majority vote of all the current mentors of the organization.

Section 2: The provisions for removal of an advisor include:

- (a) For removal of office, any member of the executive committee can propose to remove an officer with just cause. The proposal must be approved by two-thirds of the Executive Committee and two-thirds of the General Membership

Article IV: Rules of Order

Section 1: This organization shall be governed by "Robert's Rules of Order."

Article V: Amendment Section 1: These by-laws may be amended by a majority vote. (Should be similar to the constitution, but tend to be easier to amend. Example: simple majority vote, 2/3 vote, etc.)